DAY 6 | EXCEL

My Data Analyst Journey

Day 1-5 Recap: Shortcuts & Interview Prep

Everything from Week 1 in one carousel.

Ctrl Alt F4 ?

Swipe and save this >

Navigation & Selection

Move and select without the mouse

First cell (A1)	Ctrl + Home
Last used cell	Ctrl + End
Jump to edge of data	Ctrl + Arrow
Select to end of data	Ctrl + Shift + Arrow
Go To (F5 too)	Ctrl + G
Next sheet (PgUp = back)	Ctrl + PgDn
Select column	Ctrl + Space
Select row	Shift + Space

Edit & Fill

Enter data faster

Edit the cell	F2
Undo (Ctrl Y = Redo)	Ctrl + Z
Fill down (Ctrl R = right)	Ctrl + D
Fill all selected cells	Ctrl + Enter
New line inside a cell	Alt + Enter
Insert today's date	Ctrl + ;
Insert current time	Ctrl + Shift + ;
Fill Series dialog	Alt + H + F + I + S

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Format Shortcuts

Make data look professional

Bold (I = italic, U = underline)	Ctrl + B
Format Cells box	Ctrl + 1
AutoFit column width	Alt + H + O + I
Center align	Alt + H + A + C
Wrap text	Alt + H + W
Merge & Center	Alt + H + M + C
All borders	Alt + H + B + A
Cell (fill) color	Alt + H + H

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Number Format Shortcuts

One move, perfect format

Number (1,000.00)	Ctrl + Shift + !
Currency	Ctrl + Shift + $
Percentage	Ctrl + Shift + %
Date	Ctrl + Shift + #
Time	Ctrl + Shift + @
General	Ctrl + Shift + ~
Increase decimal	Alt + H + 0
Decrease decimal	Alt + H + 9

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Data Tools

Filter, sort, tables and more

Filter on / off	Ctrl + Shift + L
Open filter dropdown	Alt + Down
Sort A to Z	Alt + A + S + A
Create Excel Table	Ctrl + T
Table Total Row	Ctrl + Shift + T
Text to Columns	Alt + A + E
Flash Fill	Ctrl + E
AutoSum	Alt + =

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Copy, Paste & Find

Clipboard power moves

Paste values only	Ctrl + Alt + V + V
Transpose	Ctrl + Alt + V + E
Add (S, M, I for others)	Ctrl + Alt + V + D
Skip blanks	Ctrl + Alt + V + B
Select visible cells only	Alt + ;
Find	Ctrl + F
Find & Replace	Ctrl + H
Lock reference (A1)	F4

Audit & Clear

Check and clean your sheet

Select current region	Ctrl + Shift + *
Row differences	Ctrl + \
Select precedent cells	Ctrl + [
Select dependent cells	Ctrl +]
Trace Precedents	Alt + M + P
Trace Dependents	Alt + M + D
Show all formulas	Ctrl + `
Clear all	Alt + H + E + A

Interview: Basics

Questions you may get

Formula vs Function?

Formula: you write it (=A1+B1). Function: predefined (=SUM(A1:A5)).

Excel limits?

1,048,576 rows and 16,384 columns (A to XFD).

Workbook vs worksheet?

Workbook is the whole file. Worksheets are the pages inside it.

Constant vs formula?

Click the cell. A typed value in the Formula Bar is a constant. Starting with = is a formula.

Interview: References

Relative, absolute, mixed

Reference types?

A1 moves when copied. A1 never moves. $A1 locks the column. A$1 locks the row.

How to lock a cell?

Press F4 on the reference (Fn + F4 on many laptops).

Why not hardcode?

=A1+B1 updates by itself. =100+200 never changes.

Classic use of $?

=G5/F1 divides every row by one fixed total.

Interview: Functions

SUM, COUNT and RANK

COUNT vs COUNTA vs COUNTBLANK?

Numbers only. All non-empty cells. Empty cells only.

SUM(A1,A3) vs SUM(A1:A3)?

First adds only A1 and A3. Second adds A1, A2 and A3.

How does RANK treat ties?

Same rank, next one skipped: 9, 9, 11. Lock the list with $.

PRODUCT vs *?

Same answer. PRODUCT takes a whole range.

Interview: Table vs Range

A favourite question

	Normal Range	Excel Table
Growth	Fixed range	**Auto-expands**
Formulas	Not dynamic	**Dynamic**
Filtering	Filter only	**Filter + Slicer**
References	A1:A10	**[@Salary] names**
Totals	Manual AutoSum	**Total Row**
Merged cells	Allowed	**Not allowed**

Create a table with Ctrl+T. Go back with Table Design > Convert to Range.

Interview: Filter, Sort & CF

Show, arrange, highlight

Filter vs Conditional Formatting?

Filter hides other data. Conditional Formatting shows everything and only highlights.

What is a Slicer?

A button-style filter for Tables. Easier than the dropdown.

Sort by many levels?

Custom Sort: Department first, then Sales largest to smallest.

Conditional Formatting types?

Highlight Rules, Top/Bottom, Data Bars, Color Scales, Icon Sets.

Interview: Paste Special

Always asked

Formulas to values?

Ctrl+C > Ctrl+Alt+V > V > Enter.

Add 1000 to a whole column?

Copy 1000 > select the column > Paste Special > Add.

Skip Blanks vs Paste Link?

Skip Blanks keeps old data. Paste Link updates when the source changes.

What is Transpose?

Turns rows into columns and columns into rows.

Interview: Text Functions

Spot the difference

FIND vs SEARCH?

FIND is case-sensitive. SEARCH is not.

REPLACE vs SUBSTITUTE?

REPLACE works by position. SUBSTITUTE works by text.

CONCAT vs TEXTJOIN?

TEXTJOIN adds a delimiter and can skip empty cells.

TRIM vs CLEAN?

TRIM removes extra spaces. CLEAN removes line breaks and hidden characters.

Interview: Go To Special

Smart selection tricks

Delete blank rows?

Ctrl+G > Special > Blanks > Ctrl+- > Entire row. Use one key column.

Copy only visible cells?

Select > Alt+; > Ctrl+C > Ctrl+V.

Compare two columns?

Select both > Ctrl+\ (Row differences).

Precedents vs Dependents?

Precedents feed the cell. Dependents use the cell.

Common Excel Errors

Know what each one means

#NAME?	Typo in function name
#VALUE!	Wrong data type / not found
#DIV/0!	Divided by zero
#N/A	Value not found
#REF!	Deleted referenced cell
######	Column too narrow

You already met #NAME? (typing =some) and #VALUE! (FIND with no match).

Day 6
Done!

Your Day 1-5 shortcut and
interview cheat sheet.

Which shortcut saved you the most time?
Tell me in the comments.

Follow for Day 7

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